

Morning Briefing — Wednesday, 19 August 2026

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2. IMPORTANT NEWS

Wall Street falls for a third straight session as bond yields hit multi-decade highs

[CNBC](#) / [TheStreet](#) / [Bloomberg](#) • [close Tue 18 Aug](#)

S&P 500 -0.69% to 7,691.76; Nasdaq -1.33% to 26,289.71; Dow -0.22% to 53,343.40. A semiconductor selloff plus a surge in long-dated Treasury yields drove broad risk-off. Sets a soft tone into the European open.

30-year US Treasury yield hits a 19-year high near 5.33%, 10-year above 4.73%

[CNBC](#) • [Tue 18 Aug](#)

Driven by inflation persistence and US fiscal-deficit concerns. Direct driver of the equity selloff and pressure on rate-sensitive and growth names globally, including European tech.

AI/semiconductor selloff deepens into the Asian session — Kospi -5.2%, triggers circuit breaker

[TradingEconomics](#) / [TradingKey](#) / [Business Standard](#) • [overnight, Wed 19 Aug](#)

Samsung and SK Hynix both down roughly 7-9%; Nikkei 225 down ~2.6-2.9%. Confirms the AI-capex/chip valuation reset has gone global. Directly relevant for European semiconductor-equipment names (ASML, ASM International, BEI, Infineon) at the open.

Vessel struck in the Strait of Hormuz; US naval blockade active after July ceasefire collapse

[Al Jazeera](#) / [CNN](#) • [reported 18 Aug](#)

One crew casualty reported. CENTCOM says it has redirected, disabled or boarded dozens of commercial vessels since reimposing the blockade. Underlying driver of the risk premium keeping Brent above \$91/bbl. Iran-Oman talks continue with no resolution yet.

Fed's July FOMC minutes show a 9-3 hold vote, three regional presidents dissenting in favour of a hike

[Fed minutes coverage](#), [released 19:00 BST Wed 19 Aug](#)

First unified three-way hike dissent since September 2016 — an unusual hawkish regime. Market has since cut September hike odds from roughly two-thirds to about 31%. Central to the read-through for the BoE, which faces a similar inflation bind.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

CONTRACT	LEVEL	INDICATIVE MOVE
Euro Stoxx 50 futures	n/a (point level)	Flat to -0.5%
DAX futures	n/a (point level)	-0.10% to -0.15%
CAC 40 futures	n/a (point level)	~-0.01% (near flat)
FTSE 100 futures	n/a (point level)	-0.32% to -0.63%
US context — pre-market futures		
S&P 500 futures	n/a	~-0.7%
Nasdaq futures	n/a	~-0.7%

European futures point to a flat-to-lower open, weighed by the overnight Asia chip-stock rout and continued bond-yield and oil pressure. FTSE is the laggard on the futures screen even though it was the one European index to close higher yesterday. Exact point levels could not be verified against a live quote at collection time — treat as n/a; direction and approximate magnitude are corroborated across two sources.

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — EUROPEAN INDICES (TUE 18 AUG 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
Euro Stoxx 50	6,530	-0.1%
DAX 40	26,238	-0.38% (alt. source: -0.71%)
CAC 40	8,509.36	-0.8%
FTSE 100	10,728.04	+0.1%

Continental Europe slipped again as euro-zone bond yields hit multi-year highs (Bund 10y highest since ~2011, French OAT 10y at a 16-year peak) and Brent rose above \$91 on fading hopes of a lasting US-Iran ceasefire. Tech/chip names led STOXX 600 sector losses (Infineon -7.6%, Aixtron -8.8%, sector -2.5%). FTSE 100 was the exception, snapping a six-day losing streak on energy-stock strength (oil above \$91).

5. US MARKETS — YESTERDAY'S SESSION (TUE 18 AUG 2026 CLOSE)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,691.76	-0.69%
Dow Jones Industrial Average	53,343.40	-0.22%
Nasdaq Composite	26,289.71	-1.33%

Tone: broad risk-off, third straight down session. Ten of eleven S&P sectors fell. **Leading sector:** Energy (XLE +1.05%), oil-price driven. **Lagging sector:** Technology/semiconductors — the Philadelphia Semiconductor Index dropped sharply as chip and memory names sold off.

Key takeaway: rising long-end bond yields (30-year near 5.3%, a near two-decade high) and a renewed AI/semiconductor valuation reset — not a single earnings shock — drove the decline, with energy the only pocket of strength as oil climbed on Middle East risk.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION (WED 19 AUG 2026)

INDEX	LEVEL	CHANGE
Nikkei 225	~65,500-65,691	-2.6% to -2.9%
Kospi	~6,515.97	-5.2% CIRCUIT BREAKER
Shanghai Composite	3,927.70	-1.5%
Hang Seng	n/a	~flat to +0.2% (sources conflict)

Sharp risk-off across North Asia, led by a deepening global semiconductor/AI-valuation selloff that started on Wall Street, compounded by a surge in global bond yields (Japan's 10-year JGB yield hit its highest level in three decades). Kospi bore the brunt given its concentration in Samsung and SK Hynix (both down 7-9%), triggering a circuit-breaker mechanism. Hong Kong and mainland China were comparatively more resilient; the Hang Seng figure carries a confirmed direction of roughly flat, with the exact percentage unresolved between sources.

7. COMMODITIES

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE	CONTEXT
Brent crude	~\$91.0-91.7/bbl	roughly flat / slightly firmer	Elevated on Strait of Hormuz shipping tensions, stalled US-Iran talks
WTI crude	~\$84.9-85.2/bbl	+0.49%	Third straight up session on Hormuz supply risk
Gold (spot)	~\$4,339-4,366/oz	+0.10%	Retreating slightly this morning as yields and dollar firm, but near record territory
Natural gas (TTF, Europe)	~€62.6-63.9/MWh	+1.5% intraday	Ticked higher on lower wind generation (one source showed €54.10 — flagged discrepancy)
Natural gas (Henry Hub, US)	\$2.70/MMBtu	+0.46%	—
Copper	\$6.47/lb or ~\$14,234-14,519/tonne	sources conflict: -2.09% (lb, CFD) vs up on day (LME, tonne)	Different snapshot times/contracts — not reconciled, flagged

Copper and TTF gas figures carry cross-source discrepancies likely from different contract months/reference periods. Reported as found rather than silently reconciled.

8. RATES & FX

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE
US 10-year Treasury yield	~4.70-4.74%	easing back after touching ~4.75% (20-month high) Tuesday
German 10-year Bund yield	3.26%	+4bps (yield up / price down)
EUR/USD	1.1592	near two-month highs
GBP/USD	~1.3529-1.3533	7-day range 1.3490-1.3550
DXY (US Dollar Index)	~99.65	+0.01% to +0.04%

The dominant cross-asset story remains the long end of the curve: the US 30-year hit a 19-year high near 5.33% Tuesday and euro-area sovereign yields (Bund, OAT) are at their highest since 2011/2008-09, pressuring duration-sensitive equities including European semiconductors. Euro firm near two-month highs against the dollar despite the rates backdrop.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES

No specific EUR deal (issuer/size/coupon/spread) priced 18 Aug could be confirmed via public search — specialist DCM terminals (GlobalCapital, IFR, Bloomberg, LSEG/Refinitiv, cbonds) were not reachable from this session. n/a. Context: 18 Aug saw a broad European government-bond selloff (Bund 10y >3.25%, highest since ~2011; French OAT 10y ~4.10–4.12%, highest since 2008-09; 30y OAT near 4.85%) — a backdrop that typically makes issuers pause rather than print. The most recent confirmed EUR FIG print is SEB's €500m 11NC6 Tier 2, which reopened the euro FIG market after the summer hiatus with ~3x demand — but that priced Tuesday 11 Aug, over a week prior, so it is not "yesterday's" issuance.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED TODAY

No confirmed mandates for EUR IG/HY/SSA today — n/a. Context only: the euro covered-bond market has gone roughly seven weeks without public issuance as of mid-August; commentary expects the first post-summer print "in the next two weeks," with September/October flagged as likely to be busy. Broader SSA/corporate supply is expected to move from quiet to active later in the month, but no specific issuer names or sizes could be sourced.

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL	DIRECTION
iTraxx Main	n/a	n/a
iTraxx Crossover	~315–320bps (stale, mid-May 2026)	n/a live move
CDX IG	n/a	n/a
CDX.NA.HY	~358bps (stale, mid-May 2026)	n/a live move
Avg euro corporate IG spread	n/a (last dated reference ~120bps is too stale to report as current)	n/a

COMMENTARY

Live index levels were not sourceable this session; every real-time CDS/spread venue tried (S&P DJI, cbonds, TradingView, Bloomberg, ICE) was unreachable. The one well-sourced, dated fact strong enough to hang commentary on is the 18 Aug sovereign-bond selloff (multi-year-high Bund/OAT yields on Iran-conflict and oil-driven inflation concern, plus French budget risk) landing in the seasonally thin second half of August, with covered bonds still shut and FIG/corporate supply only just restarting post-SEB. That combination points to a tone of caution and selectivity rather than a fully open window — this is inference from macro and seasonal context, not a direct IFR/GlobalCapital tone quote, and is flagged as such.

DCM section is data-light this morning: specialist terminals were not reachable from this research session. Treat spread levels above as stale reference points, not live prices.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR — WEDNESDAY 19 AUGUST 2026

TIME (LONDON)	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
07:00	UK CPI, July (final)	Conflicting prior-month figures found — see flag below	HIGH
~04:00 (unconfirmed)	Eurozone current account, June	n/a	MEDIUM
10:00 (typical release slot)	Eurozone HICP, July (final)	Confirm flash: +2.9% y/y (from +2.8% June); energy inflation ~10.0% y/y	HIGH
19:00	US FOMC Minutes (28-29 Jul meeting)	Focus on the 9-3 hold vote and the three-way hike dissent	HIGH

UK CPI: research found two mutually contradictory prior-month figures (one source citing June at 2.6% y/y, another citing June at 2.0% y/y with July at 2.2% y/y and core at 3.3%). This must be checked directly against ons.gov.uk at/after the 07:00 release before quoting a number. No US high-importance data releases beyond the FOMC minutes were identified for today — a comparatively light US data day.

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS — TODAY

EUROPE

Carlsberg A/S (Denmark) — Q2/H1 results.

Straumann Holding AG (Switzerland) — Q2/H1 results.

Sisram Medical Ltd — results.

Actual reported figures not yet available at collection time (pre-release)
— check company IR sites shortly before publication.

UNITED STATES

Lowe's (LOW) — before open. Consensus revenue \$26.14bn (+9% y/y), EPS \$4.22 (-3% y/y); soft DIY demand vs Pro-segment strength.

Estée Lauder (EL) — before open. Consensus revenue +4% y/y, EPS \$0.32 (+255.6% y/y off a weak base).

Analog Devices (ADI) — after close. Consensus EPS \$3.33, revenue \$3.93bn (+36.2% y/y); stock near record highs, sizable post-earnings move priced.

Viking Holdings (VIK) — before open, call 8:00am ET; cruise-sector demand caution overhang.

Also reporting: Toll Brothers, La-Z-Boy, Jack Henry, BILL Holdings, Kingsoft Cloud, ZTO Express, Lufax, Weibo, Kuaishou, Full Truck Alliance, Opera — ~38 names total.

M&A context (surrounding days, not necessarily today): Deutsche Telekom acquiring Fiberhost and Inea from Macquarie Asset Management (~€1bn, 16 Aug); Alibaba selling its videogame business for at least \$1.5bn (17 Aug); Madison Air buying Airflow Technologies for \$5.4bn (18 Aug). Sourcing for these was thinner/aggregator-based — treat as directional, verify exact deal values before republishing.

12. STOCKS TO WATCH

easyJet (LSE: EZJ)	Aviation. Formally agreed a £5.7bn takeover by Apollo Global Management at £7.15/share (confirmed 7 Aug) after rival bidder Castllake withdrew.	UP
Ryanair (RYA)	Aviation. Shares fell >6% after flagging weaker-than-expected summer fares; CFO warned of possible European airline consolidation/bankruptcies ahead.	DOWN
Rolls-Royce (LSE: RR.)	Aerospace. Fresh record highs, +14% since 30 Jul H1 results; FY2026 operating-profit guidance raised to £4.7–4.9bn, interim dividend hiked 33% to 6p.	UP
A.P. Møller-Maersk	Shipping. Raised 2026 EBITDA guidance for the second time this year (now \$10.5–12.5bn vs prior \$8–10bn) on resilient container demand.	UP
Antofagasta (LSE: ANTO)	Mining/Copper. H1 EBITDA +27% to \$2.8bn on record copper margins, but FY2026 copper output guidance cut to 625k–655k tonnes after a July storm shut Los Pelambres.	DOWN / mixed
Glencore (LSE: GLEN)	Mining. Doubled its planned shareholder distribution — \$1bn top-up plus \$500m buyback — enabled by net debt falling toward its \$10bn cap.	UP
Weir Group	Mining/Industrial equipment. Upgraded to Buy by Kepler Cheuvreux (PT 2,700p) on stronger end-market expectations into 2026.	UP
Rheinmetall / Thales / Leonardo	Aerospace & Defense. RBC initiated Outperform on all three (11 Aug), sector pullback framed as a buying opportunity on ~16% annual defense-spending growth to 2030. Rheinmetall specifically remains volatile after the German F126 warship contract cancellation.	UP (sector) / mixed (RHM)
BP / Centrica	Energy. Led FTSE 100 gainers 18 Aug (BP +2.12%, Centrica +2.15%) as Brent climbed above \$91/bbl on expiry of the US-Iran interim de-escalation understanding.	UP
Wolfspeed (NASDAQ: WOLF)	Semiconductors. Reports FQ4 results today; shares sank 7.6% pre-print on margin concerns; consensus a 52c loss on \$223.6m revenue.	DOWN into print

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

Fed's July minutes reveal an unusually hawkish internal split (3 dissents for a hike, not a cut) even as markets have since pared September hike odds to ~31% — policy debate has shifted from "when to cut" to "whether to hike."

30-year UST yield at a 19-year high (~5.33%), 10-year above 4.73% — the dominant cross-asset story pressuring equities and gold alike.

Eurozone HICP flash accelerated to 2.9% y/y in July (from 2.8%), energy inflation surging to 10.0% y/y on the Iran conflict; final print due today.

BoE held rates at 3.75% on 30 July in a 6-3 vote (three wanted a hike to 4.00%); next decision 17 September, 12:00 London.

CORPORATE

Global chip/semiconductor selloff (Philadelphia Semiconductor gauge -5.5% on 18 Aug) on fears AI infrastructure capex is peaking faster than expected, spreading from the US to Korea/Japan/Taiwan overnight.

Heavy US earnings slate today spanning retail (Lowe's, Estée Lauder) and semis (Analog Devices) — a key read on whether the AI-capex/consumer-demand narrative stabilises or worsens.

European reporting light today (Carlsberg, Straumann) — modest market-mover potential versus the US names.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

Iran war (active since late February 2026) remains the dominant geopolitical risk: ceasefire collapsed in July, US naval blockade of the Strait of Hormuz reimposed, vessel struck as recently as 18 Aug. Brent trading above \$91/bbl on this risk premium.

UK political backdrop: Andy Burnham became PM on 20 July 2026 after an unopposed Labour leadership contest, replacing Keir Starmer, with John Healey as Chancellor. First Budget scheduled 28 October against warnings of a possible £24bn fiscal gap.

Fed's unusual three-way hawkish dissent adds a US monetary-political dimension worth watching for any Fed-independence narrative.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5

1. UK July CPI, 07:00

Sets the tone directly ahead of the BoE's 17 Sept decision; prior-month figures conflict between sources — verify at release.

2. UK labour market overview

Payrolled employees down ~94k y/y, real regular pay growth just 0.7% — a soft-labour read the BoE will weigh.

3. US retail earnings: Lowe's, Target

A direct read on US consumer resilience after July retail sales fell for the first time in nine months.

4. Oil above \$91-92/bbl

Third consecutive rise as the US-Iran interim MOU lapsed 17 Aug without renewal, reviving Hormuz disruption risk.

5. US 30-year yield ~5.30-5.33%

Highest since 2007; UK/German/French/Japanese long yields also near multi-decade highs, pressuring duration-sensitive names into the open.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

1. US FOMC minutes, Wed 19 Aug

The week's headline US data point, key for gauging the Fed's internal debate ahead of the 16 Sept decision.

2. US retail earnings trio

Home Depot beat 18 Aug; Target/Lowe's report Wed; Walmart closes the group Thu — the market's clearest read on US consumer health this month.

3. UK CPI + labour data, Wed 19 Aug

Directly frames BoE rate-path expectations into September.

4. Gilt-market stress tied to PM Burnham

30-year gilt near 5.75% (2-month high), 10-year above 5% for the longest stretch since July 2008, after Burnham's fiscal-flexibility comments spooked bond investors.

5. US-Iran / Strait of Hormuz talks

Iran-Oman negotiations continue on shipping-lane management; any breakdown or breakthrough is an immediate oil-price swing factor.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

1. Jackson Hole Symposium, 27-29 Aug

Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's first keynote (Fri 28 Aug), the year's key venue for rate-path signalling ahead of September FOMC.

2. Nvidia earnings, Wed 26 Aug

Coincides with US July PCE the same day — an AI-valuation and Fed-inflation catalyst in one session.

3. FOMC decision, 16 Sept

Widely framed as a likely first cut, but probability estimates diverge sharply by source — genuinely uncertain, not consensus.

4. US tariff calendar

125% reciprocal-tariff escalation paused for a further 90 days from 11 Aug; broader suspension expires 10 Nov.

5. UK Autumn Budget, 28 Oct

First Budget under PM Burnham's government, delivered by Chancellor Healey; positioning and speculation to build through the rest of August.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY

UK CPI and labour-market release (07:00) — first mover for gilts, GBP and FTSE at the open.

Oil trajectory above \$91/bbl on Hormuz risk — bullish for BP/Shell/Centrica, bearish for airlines (easyJet, IAG, Wizz, Ryanair).

Read-through from US pre-market prints (Wolfspeed, Target, Lowe's) into European futures and risk appetite.

Continued bond-market pressure (UST 30y ~5.3%, gilts elevated) weighing on rate-sensitive and high-duration equities.

Idiosyncratic broker-note flow (e.g. Weir Group upgrade) driving single-stock moves.

1 WEEK

Wed 19 Aug: UK CPI (07:00) + US FOMC minutes (19:00).

Wed-Thu: Target/Lowe's then Walmart earnings — US consumer resilience test.

US housing data already out this week: Empire State Index (Mon), Housing Starts (Tue).

Ongoing gilt-market watch tied to PM Burnham's fiscal commentary.

Any fresh Iran/Hormuz developments given the lapsed US-Iran MOU.

1 MONTH

Jackson Hole Symposium, 27-29 Aug — Fed Chair Warsh's debut address is the key deadline for rate-cut signalling.

Nvidia earnings + US PCE, both 26 Aug — pivotal for AI valuations and the Fed's preferred inflation gauge simultaneously.

FOMC decision, 16 Sept — probability estimates for a first cut vary widely; treat as unresolved.

US-China tariff track: 90-day pause from 11 Aug on the 125% escalation; broader suspension deadline 10 Nov.

UK political/fiscal transition under PM Burnham — building toward the 28 Oct Autumn Budget under new Chancellor Healey.

SOURCES

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Data collected automatically via live web search. Verify before making any decision. Several data points above are explicitly marked n/a or flagged as conflicting between sources — do not treat them as confirmed.